

The Cost of Always Being Busy: The Second Attempt

忙碌的代价：第二次尝试

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The second attempt had a **minimal requirement** and a **maximal** ambition: one **indoor** session a week, provided the club could find a room. “We are not asking for a large provision,” Maya said. “We are asking for the series to exist.” A **lucky** student in a **nearby suburb** offered the hall of a **skating** club, and the nation of small habits began to take shape.

The **ratio** of talk to movement was the first **oddity**. A **nervous doctoral** student measured the **intake** of sugar, the **approximate intake** of salt, and the **proverbial intake** of advice; the **laughter** that followed was **genuine** and slightly uneasy. “A **fake** plan and a **conceptual** one look identical on paper,” she said, “and only one of them survives contact with a **suitcase**.”

The **atmospheric** part was harder: a **windy suburb**, an **outer** ring road, and a **nightmare** of bus connections. “**Hospitality** is not **entertainment**,” the **easy-going** coach said. “It is the **interruption** you do not mind.” A **resemblance** between the two approaches existed, but the **inner** one had **vitality** and the **outer** one had a poster.

The **prevention** work was almost invisible. “An **occurrence** of injury is not a **sexual** matter and not a moral one,” the physiotherapist said. “It is an event with a date.” **Arousal**, **sleepiness**, and an **amusing oddity** in the data all pointed the same way: the second attempt had to be boring on purpose.

The **conceptual** shift was to treat rest as part of the exercise. “An **existent** body is not a **spherical** one,” the coach said. “It has a history and a knee.” The **sleepiness** of the room at four o'clock, the smell of a **conditioner** bottle, and the sound of a distant match on the radio: all of it was the second attempt, and it was **possibly** the last one they would be given. The effort was especially difficult in the **outskirts**, where the music of the club never reached and a hot meal was a hit or a miss. “You watch a war of small habits,” the coach said, “and you are **optimistic** only because you are **asleep**.” The second attempt had to pass through those districts before it could call itself a programme.

中文翻译

第二次尝试有着极小的必要条件与极大的雄心：每周一次室内训练，只要俱乐部能找到一间屋子。“我们不是在要求一大笔拨款，”曼雅说，“我们要求的是让这个系列存在下去。”附近郊区一位幸运的学生提供了溜冰俱乐部的场地，而那个由小习惯组成的国家开始成形。

谈话与运动的比率是第一个奇特之处。一位紧张的在读博士生测量了糖的摄入量、盐的大致摄入量，以及“建议”这个谚语式的摄入量；随之而来的笑声是真诚的，也略带不安。“假计划和概念性的计划在纸上看起来一模一样，”她说，“而其中只有一种能挺过与一只行李箱的接触。”

气氛那部分更难：一个多风的郊区、一条外环道路，以及一场公交换乘的噩梦。“好客不是娱乐，”那位随和的教练说，“它是不介意的那次打断。”两种做法之间确实有相似之处，但内在的那一种有生命力，外在的那一种只有一张海报。

预防工作几乎是看不见的。“一次受伤的发生既不是性方面的事，也不是道德的事，”理疗师说，“它是一次有日期的事件。”激发、困倦，以及数据里一处有趣的怪事，都指向同一个方向：第二次尝试必须故意做得很无聊。

概念上的转变是把休息当作训练的一部分。“一具存在的身体不是球形的，”教练说，“它有来历，也有膝盖。”四点钟屋里那股困倦、一只护发素瓶子的气味，以及收音机里一场远处比赛的声音：所有这些都是第二次尝试，而这很可能是他们最后一次机会。这份努力在市郊尤其艰难，那里俱乐部的音乐从不到达，一顿热饭也时有时无。“你看着一场小习惯之间的战争，”教练说，“而你之所以乐观，只是因为你睡着了。”第二次尝试必须穿过那些片区，才能称自己为一个项目。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
attempt ə'tempt POS: n	n. 尝试, 企图; vt. 尝试, 企图 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. earnest and conscientious activity intended to do or accomplish something
sexual 'sekʃuəl POS: a	a. 性的, 性别的; [医] 性的; 性欲的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or characterized by sexuality; a. having or involving sex
requirement ri'kwaɪəmənt POS: n	n. 需求, 必要条件, 要求; [化] 要求; 合同要求 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. required activity
possibly 'pɒsəbli POS: adv	adv. 可能, 也许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. by chance; r. to a degree possible of achievement or by possible means
inner 'inə POS: a	a. 内部的, 内心的; n. 内部 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. located inward; a. located or occurring within or closer to a center; s. innermost or essential; s. exclusive...
lucky 'lʌki POS: a	a. 幸运的, 吉祥的, 好运的, 侥幸的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. occurring by chance; a. having or bringing good fortune
entertainment ,entə'teɪnmənt POS: n	n. 娱乐, 款待, 娱乐表演 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an activity that is diverting and that holds the attention
ratio 'reɪʃəʊ POS: n	n. 比, 比率; [医] 比, 比率, 比例 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relative magnitudes of two quantities (usually expressed as a quotient)
nervous 'nɜ:vəs POS: a	a. 神经紧张的, 不安的, 神经的; [医] 神经的; 神经质的, 神经过敏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. easily agitated; a. of or relating to the nervous system
nearby 'niəbaɪ POS: a	a. 附近的, 近旁的; adv. 在附近, 近旁地; prep. 在...附近 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. close at hand; r. not far away in relative terms
genuine 'dʒenjuɪn POS: a	a. 真正的, 真实的, 诚恳的; [医] 真性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not fake or counterfeit; s. not pretended; sincerely felt or expressed
asleep ə'sli:p POS: a	a. 睡着的, 长眠的, 麻木的; adv. 熟睡地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. in a state of sleep; s. lacking sensation; s. dead; r. into a sleeping state
outer 'aʊtə POS: a	a. 外部的, 外面的, 在外的, 远离中心的; [机] 外部的, 外面的, 外侧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being on the outside or further from a center; s. located outside; s. being on or toward the outside of the...
laughter 'lɑ:ftə POS: n	n. 笑, 笑声; [医] 笑, 大笑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of laughing; the manifestation of joy or mirth or scorn
suburb 'sʌbə:b POS: n	n. 市郊住宅区, 郊区, 边缘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a residential district located on the outskirts of a city
nightmare 'naɪtmɛə POS: n	n. 梦魇, 恶梦, 可怕的事物(或情景、人物); [医] 梦魇, 恶梦 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a situation resembling a terrifying dream; n. a terrifying or deeply upsetting dream
prevention pri'venʃən POS: n	n. 阻止, 妨碍, 预防; [医] 预防 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of preventing
optimistic ,opti'mistik POS: a	a. 乐观的, 乐观主义的, 乐天的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. expecting the best in this best of all possible worlds
minimal 'miniml POS: a	a. 最小的, 极微的, 最小限度的; [医] 最小的, 最低的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. the least possible
occurrence ə'kʌrəns POS: n	n. 发生, 事件, 出现; [医] 发生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an instance of something occurring
intake 'inteɪk POS: n	n. 入口, 吸入, 吸入量; [医] 摄取量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an opening through which fluid is admitted to a tube or container
fake feɪk POS: n	n. 假货, 欺骗, 诡计; a. 假的; vt. 假造, 伪造; vi. 伪装 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is a counterfeit; not what it seems to be; s. not genuine or real; being an imitation of the...
conceptual ken'septʃuəl POS: a	a. 概念的; [医] 概念的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being or characterized by concepts or their formation
suitcase 'sju:tkeɪs POS: n	n. 手提箱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a portable rectangular container for carrying clothes

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
hospitality ˌhɒspɪ'tælɪti POS: n	n. 款待, 亲切, 殷勤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n kindness in welcoming guests or strangers
indoor ˈɪndoː POS: a	a. 户内的, 室内的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. located, suited for, or taking place within a building; s. within doors
amusing ə'mjuːzɪŋ POS: a	a. 有趣的, 引人发笑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. providing enjoyment; pleasantly entertaining; s. arousing or provoking laughter
resemblance rɪ'zembləns POS: n	n. 相似处, 类似, 肖像 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. similarity in appearance or external or superficial details
interruption ˌɪntə'rʌpʃən POS: n	n. 打扰, 中断, 障碍物; [医] 间断, 阻断, 中止 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. some abrupt occurrence that interrupts an ongoing activity
atmospheric ætməs'ferɪk POS: a	a. 大气的; [医] 大气的; 大气压的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or located in the atmosphere
outskirts ˈaʊtskəːts POS: n	n. 近郊, 市郊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. outlying areas (as of a city or town)
doctoral ˈdɒktərəl POS: a	a. 博士的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to a doctor or doctorate
vitality vaɪ'tælɪti POS: n	n. 活力, 生命力; [医] 生机, 活力, 生活 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an energetic style
conditioner kən'dɪʃəneɪ POS: n	n. 调节器, 土壤团粒结构促进剂; [计] 调节器, 整形器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. exercise that conditions the body; n. a trainer of athletes; n. a substance used in washing (clothing or hair)
windy ˈwɪndi POS: a	a. 多风的, 风强的, 腹胀的, 吹牛的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. resembling the wind in speed, force, or variability
arousal ə'raʊzl POS: n	n. 奋发, 激励 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of arousing; n. a state of heightened physiological activity; n. awakening from sleep
approximate ə'prɒksɪmət POS: a	a. 大约的, 接近的, 近似的; vt. 接近, 使接近, 粗略估计; vi. 接近于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be close or similar; s. not quite exact or correct; s. very close in resemblance; s. located close together
proverbial prə'veːbiəl POS: a	a. 谚语的, 谚语式的, 闻名的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or resembling or expressed in a proverb; s. widely known and spoken of
skating ˈskeɪtɪŋ POS: n	n. 溜冰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sport of gliding on skates
oddity ˈɒdɪti POS: n	n. 奇异, 奇特, 怪人, 怪事, 怪僻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. eccentricity that is not easily explained; n. a strange attitude or habit
spherical ˈsferɪkl POS: a	a. 球的, 球面的, 球状的, 天体的; [医] 球形的, 球状的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to spheres or resembling a sphere
maximal ˈmæksɪml POS: a	a. 最大的, 最高的; [医] 最大的, 最高的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. the greatest or most complete or best possible
sleepiness ˈsliːpɪnis POS: n	n. 睡意; [医] 瞌睡, 欲睡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a very sleepy state
existent ɪg'zɪstənt POS: a	a. 存在的, 生存的, 现存的; [医] 生存者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having existence or being or actuality
easy-going phonetic unavailable POS: a	a. 随和的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. Moving easily; hence, mild-tempered; ease-loving;; inactive.